Interview Questions for Rowena Chadwick-Smith

Producer, singer, and multi-instrumentalist, Huddersfield · Founder, Beatify

> **How this works:** answer in writing or by voice note, whichever is easier. Answers don't need to be polished, and you can skip any question. I'll shape them into a piece for the blog.
>
> Voice notes from your phone's voice memo app are perfect. Send them as replies or through a Google Drive link.

01 You started singing at 17 and have been producing your own music for about 20 years. What got you making tracks, and where does the name DJ Robbyn come from?

02 Your albums cover dubstep, trance, world, and Christian music. When you start a song, do you know its genre yet, or does the style show up as you build it?

03 With Rob you make music as Symbiotik and as Equal Frequencies. How do you split the work between you, and how do you decide which project a new song belongs to?

04 *Desert of Contrast*, your Symbiotik debut about the seven ages of man, came back this year for its 10th anniversary. What was it like to revisit it, and did you change anything?

05 As a drummer, I'm curious how you build beats. Do you program them, play them in on pads, or start from loops? And with a song called "Me and My Machines," what's in your studio?

06 Your new video for "Static" is about the noise of self-doubt and the relief of meeting someone who hears it. How did the song come together, and how did you plan the visuals?

07 You taught yourself to code to build Beatify, a music app for beginners and kids. Why build it yourself, and what's the first thing you hope a new user makes with it?

08 You wrote *An Introduction to Music Theory*. How much theory is in your head when you produce? And I've seen your other books described differently, so what are they about?

09 What's your PhD in AI music about, and where do you see AI fitting into music?

10 What advice would you give a young musician, maybe a high school drummer like me, who wants to make and release their own music?

Thank you, Rowena. No rush at all. **Damon**, The Session Notes